

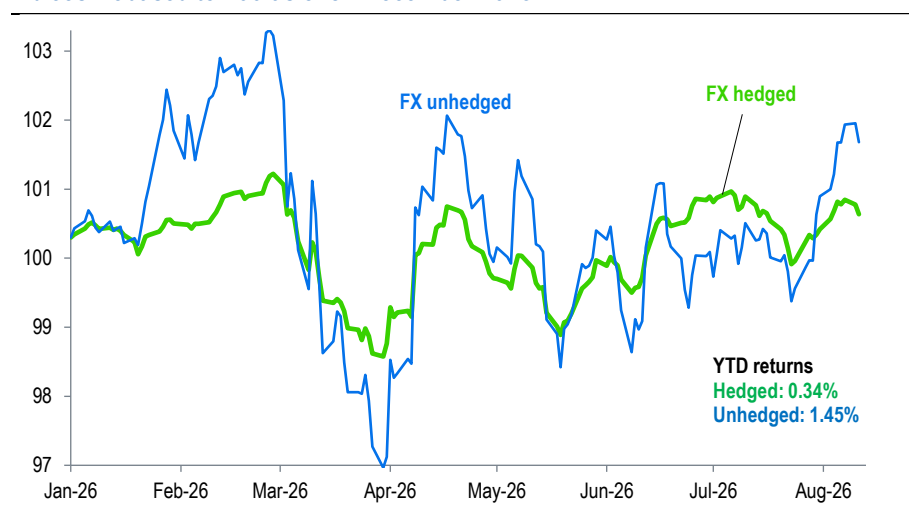


EM rates overview – Supportive carry

- Lower energy prices, USD stability and softer inflation favour tactical exposure to EM LCY rates
- Carry and roll remain supportive of EM LCY debt performance; valuations limit broad yield compression
- We are *Positive* on duration in Korea, Czech Republic, Brazil and Mexico; *Neutral* elsewhere

Figure 1: EM LCY debt performance has improved since mid-July

Indices* rebased to 100 as of 31 December 2025



*Bloomberg EM LCY 10% country cap index; Source: Bloomberg, Standard Chartered Research

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Key data/events

	SC	Cons	Prior
Monday 17 Aug			
JP GDP annualized SA, % q/q	2	2.1	1.8
SG Non-oil domestic exports, % y/y	25.7	25.7	20.7
TH GDP, % y/y	1.4	1.8	2.8
MY CPI, % y/y	2	1.9	1.9
CN IP, % y/y (2Y CAGR)	4.6	5.0	5.3
	(5.1)	(-)	(6.0)
PH Overseas remittances, % y/y	2.0	2.0	2.0
CA CPI, % m/m	0.4	0.5	-0.4
Tuesday 18 Aug			
MY Exports, % y/y	35.4	34.7	45.4
UK Avg. weekly earnings 3m, % y/y	3.9	3.9	4.3
UK ILO unemployment rate, %	4.9	4.8	4.9

Limited room

The EM LCY asset class has entered a more constructive tactical window in August, although we see limited scope for a sustained broad-based duration rally. The retracement in oil prices from recent peaks, a more stable USD and softer inflation momentum have reduced immediate pressure on EM central banks to hike. Recent downside inflation surprises across several markets are encouraging, with commodity and input price momentum moderating and imported inflation pressures easing. We expect this to support the asset class in the near term if geopolitical tensions continue to fade. YTD, EM LCY debt has posted gains of 1.45% on an FX-unhedged basis and 0.34% on an FX-hedged basis (*The Rates Standard – Tactical opportunities*)

Overall, we remain tactically constructive but selective in EM LCY markets. Softer inflation, stable FX and light positioning are supportive, but elevated global yields and tighter valuations limit the case for a broad rally. We therefore expect carry, relative value and idiosyncratic country differentiation to continue to drive EM LCY returns. We are *Positive* on rates in Brazil, Mexico, the Czech Republic and Korea.

Top reads

1. *The Africa Standard* – Still searching for carry pick-up
2. *The Morning Standard* – China – Infrastructure FAI likely stayed weak in July
3. *Local Markets Alert* – EM flow dynamics – Risk appetite likely to pick up
4. *Economics Weekly* – 14 Aug – Flurry of European data
5. *The Rates Standard* – Tactical opportunities

Risk Appetite Index

Strategy (based on)	Momentum (daily)	Always on (10DMA)	Reversal (daily)
Signal	None	Risk off	None
Risk on: Long high-beta/commodity-linked FX vs short low-beta FX/gold			
Risk off: Long low-beta FX/gold vs short high-beta/commodity-linked FX			

Flagship reports

- On the Ground – Malaysia – Growth on a firm footing
- The Rates Standard* – Tactical opportunities
- The Africa Standard* – Still searching for carry pick-up
- On the Ground – Europe – Under the weather
- Economic Alert* – India – Raising our FY27 CPI forecast
-  *Global Focus* – Economic Outlook H2-2026 – A test of resilience
-  *Podcast* – Global outlook H2-2026: A test of resilience

Weekly updates

Economics Weekly
Asia data previews
EM flow dynamics

Forecast tables

Economics	FX
Rates	Commodities

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The Morning Standard

Recent publications

On the Ground – Malaysia – Growth on a firm footing

Live trades

Figure 2: Standard Chartered Research trading portfolio – FX (model portfolio)

Trade	Instrument	Current spot	Current forward outright	P&L	Entry	Entry date	Target	Stop	Analyst(s)
<i>Sell EUR-XOF</i>	12M NDF	655.97	676.0	0.0%	671.0	27-Jan-26	655.95	700.0	<i>Gadio, Kwapong</i>

Source: Standard Chartered Research

Figure 3: Standard Chartered Research trading portfolio – Rates (model portfolio)

Trade	Current	Return*	Entry	Entry date	Target	Stop	Analyst(s)
<i>Buy 12M SRBI, FX-hedged[#]</i>	4.78%	77bps	4.78%	17-Jun-26	3.98%^	5.18%^	<i>Kulkarni, Sadasivam</i>
<i>Nigeria – OMO bills offer steady returns</i>	20.31%	-171bps	18.60%	1-Apr-26	— [#]	24.00%	<i>Gadio</i>
<i>Buy 30 March 2027 Egypt T-bills</i>	25.93%	-258bps	23.35%	24-Mar-26	23.35%	27.00%	<i>Gadio, Agarwal</i>
<i>Egypt – Buy 3Y local bond</i>	24.35%	-50bps	23.85%	10-Oct-24	17.50%	27.00%	<i>Gadio</i>
<i>Nigeria – Buy Feb 2034 NIGB bond</i>	17.50%	200bps	19.50%	2-Apr-24	14.50%	23.00%	<i>Gadio</i>

* Does not represent total return; ^ for indication only; [#] Hold to maturity; Source: Standard Chartered Research

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